

Sony WF-C700N

Delivering on the promises made

The latest in Sony's lineup of TWS earbuds are their WF-C700N TWS earbuds.

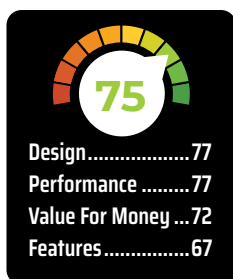
These aim to fill the gap between the cheaper WF-C500 and the WF-LS90N (aka LinkBuds S). Sony has borrowed the design of these earbuds from the budget C500 and some of the hardware from the pricier products in its lineup. I was told that these earbuds are targeted to deliver quality ANC and be one of the lightest offerings in the budget. Sony has been quite keen on penetrating the Indian audio market, so when these earbuds showed at the Digit Test Centre, I was curious to see if they stand out to the Indian consumer in a market filled with options like the Nothing Ear (2) and the Jabra Elite 4, both of which have a cult-like following. So, here's my review of the Sony WF-C700N –

BUILD AND DESIGN

When you look at the case of the Sony WF-C700N, you are instantly reminded of the WF-C500. The brand has made it to be the better specced and pricier cousin of their mid-tier TWS earbuds. The C700N carries over a LOT of the design from the C500 and leaves little to be desired when it comes to day-to-day use.

The buds, with their rounded design, fit well in the ears. I have an affinity for earbuds with short stems. However, when I was testing the WF-C700N, I was pleasantly surprised. They are lightweight, and you get three options of ear tips in the box to pair with them to ensure that you are getting a great fit when you are putting them on. It is especially important because the ANC performance of the earbuds is dependent on the fit that you are getting with the buds. While on the topic of ANC, its addition to the earbuds means that we get one of the most standout changes to the design of the buds. To accommodate the microphones

₹8,990



for ANC, Sony has added its signature circular grills to the earbuds, which makes them differentiable from the C500, which would not have been the case if it wasn't there.

The case of the earbuds comes with a solid textured top, with the rest of the body carrying a similar design from the C500. While at first, it looks solid and robust, as far as my experience with such materials and texture goes, the textured top is an open invitation for dust and gunk to accumulate over time. With that said, if you are regularly cleaning it with a damp cloth and taking care of the case, there shouldn't be much to worry about.

The case is very pocketable, with the rounded edges ensuring that sliding it in and out of your pocket is easy and it does not get stuck in the lining of your pockets. The magnets used to hold the earbuds in place are strong. The same is the case with the ones holding the lid in place. However, in my day-to-day use, I found them to be a bit too strong, and I found opening the case with one hand a task.

With the C500, our lead audio reviewer, Dhriti, noted that the physical control buttons, in place of touch/capaci-

tive controls, are something that should have been changed. She had very rightly noted that the very act of pressing the buttons to trigger basic actions repeatedly could lead to stress in the inner ear, as the earbuds are being pushed further into the ear canal with each push. With these earbuds, Sony seems to have addressed that, with the button press feeling much softer. However, that introduces the problem of accidental triggers, which were a common thing for me. The buds have IPX4 water resistance. Now this is also something I would also want the brand to rework in the next release. Now, let's look at the features that the Sony WF-C700N comes packing with and how they fare against those of the competitors.

FEATURES

The are two main areas where Sony has made changes to the C700N over the C500 TWS earbuds in terms of features – multi-point connection and Active Noise Cancellation. As I mentioned before, the C700N bring to the table Active Noise Cancellation to a pair that, despite the lack of it, was impressive and popular in the Indian market. The addition of ANC has not only made it better but also opened it up to a whole new consumer and competitor segment. And ANC also means a hike in price, which is justifiable, given the quality of ANC, is better than many other competing earbuds. More on that in the next section.

With the growing number of people getting into hybrid working/study environments, multi-point connectivity is in this transitionary phase, where it is going from being a novelty to now becoming a necessity. Sony has caught up to that trend and has added it to the C700N. Now, given that it is Sony, I expected the feature to work well, and it did!

The Headphones Connect app is not my favourite, mainly because of its interface, which in my opinion, is a bit overwhelming at times. However, it does provide for almost everything that you would need from a TWS companion app. There are customisability options lathered throughout so that you can make the earbuds truly your own.